
Other (invisible) outcomes for participants

The outcomes of transdisciplinary education are not always immediately visible, unlike an innovative concept. A deeper understanding, discovering what you don't know yet, and mapping multiple perspectives - are valuable results themselves. This text prepares you and your team members for these potential outcomes.

Outcome: a solution or a better understanding

The exact direction in which you and your team explore solutions is not predetermined. The goal of transdisciplinary learning is to be innovative, which carries the risk that you may not make significant progress toward a directly applicable solution.

It can also be valuable to spend more time investigating and understanding the problem to create a better understanding of the issue from various perspectives. Many solutions to wicked problems turn out to be unsuitable because the problem itself is misunderstood. Therefore, the act of better mapping a wicked

problem is a crucial outcome in itself.

Understanding the unknown

You may discover that there might not be a direct solution to the problem you're working on— this understandably can be a significant disappointment. However, this lesson is an outcome as well. It gives you the opportunity to take a step back, redefine the problem, and examine the system in which the problem has arisen. This way, you might arrive at new questions or identify other issues that need to be addressed first to tackle the original complex problem.

Understanding multiple perspectives

Another outcome is gaining a better understanding of different perspectives on the same problem (Oonk et al., 2022). This can be achieved by collaborating with people from another discipline, sector, or cultural background. These collaborations allow you to cross (imaginary) boundaries in a positive way. It also provides an opportunity to reflect on your own perspective: how do I view the problem? And why? By understanding your own perspective and that of others, you gain a grasp of the complexity of wicked problems.